TAWEN PASSDOWN CEREMONY

Welcome to the ŦÁ¸WEN Passdown Ceremony. This event is steeped in tradition and meaning, and though it may be long, I promise it will be a memorable and heartfelt experience.

Before we dive into the ceremony, I want to start with an activity that echoes the spirit of gratitude we share during our house meetings, this is also reminiscent of an activity we did during the YR49 first orientation week with Rebecca. This lovely activity was suggested by Sam.

I'll begin with this ball of yarn, connecting it to my wrist. I'll share my favourite thing about this house, something I'm grateful for, or something I'm going to miss about this ŦÁ¸WEN cohort. Then, I'll toss the yarn to someone else, who will do the same. By the end, we'll all be connected, a symbolic reminder of our bond and shared memories.

[YARN ACTIVITY]

Now that we've created our web of gratitude, we can proceed with the ceremony. This tradition has been passed down through the ages, from the earliest generations to us today. Each passdown is filled with meaning and love, as cherished items are given by second years to the next generation of the ŦÁ¸WEN family. While it might be hard to let go of these treasured objects, it is now your turn to receive them, to hold them dear, and to carry forward the legacy of our house. We will begin the ceremony from here. Each second year will stand up, one by one, with their passdowns ready to give away. First years, please stand up to receive your passdowns and share a hug with your second years. We will continue this process until everyone has had their turn, completing the circle. House royalty will be given last.

Let's embrace this moment together, honouring the past and looking forward to the future. Welcome to the ŦÁ¸WEN Passdown Ceremony.

[PASSDOWN CEREMONY]

Speech about being house spirit, what it means to me, what it means for the future and who i got it from blah blah blah

[GO TO THE TREE]

We come back to this tree, and instead of donating sticks, I want you all to find a branch or leaf to stand by and fan this tree with words of gratitude and hope. As you do this, look around at your new second-year cohort and give all your love and support to the growth of this tree, and therefore our house. Once you're done, you may sit down, and we will continue the ceremony.

[SITTING DOWN, POST-TREE ACTIVITY]

We gather at this tree, a symbol of the continuous growth of not only Tawen House but of all of us as individuals and as a family. What we put into this tree mirrors what we put into our community,

contributing to its proliferation and continuity. Jordan taught me a word: ephemeral. I think it's the perfect word to sum up the Pearson journey. Year 49, we first met here last year at our initiation with our second years. We then came back to close off the year with our second years doing this very tradition. Then, we became the second years and gathered with our first years here for their initiation. And now, we end our journey as an ephemeral cohort. The specialness of this family lies in the time we gather together. This tree, standing tall and steadfast, has witnessed our moments of joy, laughter, tears, and growth. It has seen us at our most vulnerable and our most triumphant. Every gathering here, every tradition, every story shared under its branches has woven us together into a tapestry of memories that will forever be a part of us.

As we stand here today, let us remember the roots we've planted—not just in this soil but in each other's hearts. The roots of friendships that have grown deeper with every shared experience, the roots of knowledge that have expanded with every lesson learned, and the roots of love that have flourished with every act of kindness. These houses mean something different to everyone. While they represent the broad elements of earth, air, fire, the moon, and of course water, their significance to each individual varies. To get off script a bit: to me, this house is my home and family. I left home scared to be alone, but I realized that in this house, I'm never really alone. From dayroom talks to screams in the forest to gossip sessions on the floor, every experience has provided me with more depth than any other part of my life. These two years have truly been the best years of my life. I've gained a family that will stay with me no matter where we all go. The amount of love I have for this house and everyone in it is unquantifiable. No matter where I go or where any of us go, we will always be tied back to this very house.

Ephemeral, ephemeral reminds us of the fleeting nature of time. Our days at Pearson, though short, are filled with moments that shape us, define us, and prepare us for the world beyond these walls. We have learned to cherish each moment, to embrace the present, and to understand that while our time here may be brief, its impact is everlasting.

We are a family forged in the fire of shared experiences, bound by the laughter that echoed through these halls, and strengthened by the challenges we faced together. The bonds we've formed here are truly unbreakable, and the memories we've created are treasures we will carry with us always. Even As we prepare to embark on new journeys, let us carry the spirit of Tawen House with us. To my fellow Year 49s, thank you for being a part of this incredible journey. Thank you for the late-night conversations, the spontaneous adventures, the unwavering support, and the endless love. Each of you has left an indelible mark on my heart, and for that, I am eternally grateful. And to my Year 50s, thank you for the reinvigorated spirit you brought. Your energy, passion, and friendships have all supplied me with so much hope and joy. Each of you has added a unique spark to our house, making it more vibrant and alive. Thank you in advance for continuing not only this legacy but also the legacy of generations. Your contributions will shape the future of our house, and I have no doubt that you will carry forward the values and love that have defined us.

Let us leave this place not with sadness, but with hope and excitement for the future. Let us remember that, like this tree, we will continue to grow and flourish, nourished by the love and lessons we've shared here. Our journey may be ephemeral, but its impact is timeless.